

REFLECTION CONTROLLER

INSTALLATION & OPERATION GUIDE · VERSION 1.0



WEB-BASED
CONTROL PANEL



START / STOP
CONTROL



GUIDED
SETUP

Purpose · Prerequisites · Installation
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1 Purpose

The Controller provides a web-based interface to start and stop the Reflection service. This manual covers the complete setup of the Controller on a client machine, along with the steps required to start and use it afterward.

2 Prerequisites

- A pendrive/CD/DVD containing the Controller setup zip file ("giz" package).
- Access to the target VM/server with a user account that has permission to run shell commands.
- Node.js — a bundled runtime is provided with the package, so a separate global installation is not required (see the note in Section 4).
- **Controller should be on the same vm where reflector is deployed**

3 Installation Steps

Step 1. Copy the setup package

Copy the zip file onto the target machine.

Step 2. Extract the package

Change into the "giz" directory and extract the archive:

```
cd <giz directory>
tar -xzf <giz name>
```

Step 3. Move into the Controller setup directory

Change into the extracted `controllerSetup` directory.

```
cd controllerSetup
```

Step 4. Refresh the Monkshu symlink

Remove the old Monkshu symlink for `controller-backend` and create a new one:

```
./monkshu/rmlink controller-backend
./monkshu/mklink controller-backend
```

Step 5. Configure the controller-backend hostname

Edit the hostname configuration file and set the correct hostname for this deployment:

```
controller-backend/backend/apps/controller-backend/conf/hostname.json
```

Step 6. Configure SSL for controller-backend (if required)

If SSL is required for this deployment, edit the SSL configuration file accordingly:

```
controller-backend/backend/apps/controller-backend/conf/httpd.json
```

Step 7. Configure the Controller environment file

Edit the Controller's `.env` file to set the host, port, and protocol for the UI, as well as the host and protocol for controller-backend — matching whatever SSL configuration was set in Step 6:

```
reflection-controller/.env
```

Step 8. Rebuild npm packages

Run the install script to rebuild the required npm packages:

```
./install.sh
```

Step 9. Update the Crashguard configuration

Edit the Crashguard process configuration and set the correct paths for Monkshu, reflection-controller, and Node:

```
./crashguard/conf/process.json
```

Step 10. Provide sudo privileges to the VM user for stop/restart commands only

Follow the instructions in the Reflection Controller README to grant the VM user sudo privileges to run only the stop and restart commands:

```
./reflection-controller/README.md
```

Step 11. Configure the Reflection service name

Edit the controller-backend service configuration and set the Reflection service name. This name must match the service name permitted in the command allow-list configured in Step 10:

```
./controller-backend/backend/apps/controller-backend/conf/service.json
```

Step 12. Launch the Controller

Run Crashguard to launch both the Controller's backend and frontend:

```
./crashguard/crashguard.js
```

NOTE

`controllerSetup/node-runtime/bin/node` is Node v24.0 and can be used if you do not want to install Node 24 globally on the machine (`/usr/bin/node`). The `install.sh` script uses `node-runtime/bin/node` for the npm rebuild by default, and the default Crashguard configuration also points to node-runtime for Node by default.

4 Using the Controller

Once Crashguard has launched the Controller's backend and frontend (Step 12), open the Controller UI in a browser using the host, port, and protocol configured in the `.env` file (Step 7).

From the UI, the Reflection service can be started or stopped using the corresponding controls. These actions are carried out through controller-backend, using the service name configured in Step 11.

5 Verification

- Confirm the Controller UI loads at the configured host and port.
- Confirm the Start/Stop actions correctly start and stop the Reflection service on the machine.
- If an action fails, re-check the service name in `service.json` (Step 11) and the command allow-list from the README (Step 10).
- If the UI does not load, re-check the `.env` values (Step 7) and the hostname/SSL configuration (Steps 5–6).



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SUPPORT

Before contacting support, collect: the document revision shown on the cover; the Node.js version in use; the monkshu logs for the affected time window; and the exact .env, hostname.json, httpd.json, and service.json values in use, with any secrets or credentials redacted before sending them to anyone.

EMAIL

support@tekmonks.com

HOURS

9.00 am to 9.00 pm IST (Monday - Friday)

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